# Mugasha
# Performed by Habib Suliman
# (1950 recording)

Translated and edited by P.S.

*Mugasha* is surely the most well-known Haya heroic ballad, and Habib Suliman's many recorded versions of it have traveled far. Its story concerns a courtship and marriage between two supernatural beings of markedly different social standings: Mugasha, the lowly fisher-god, controller of the spirits of Lake Victoria, and Lyanyaibungo, beautiful daughter of the god-king Wamara.

Mugasha is a beloved spirit, a controller of the rain and lake species that provide human sustenance, a friend of ironsmiths and potters, and a social grotesque who flouts the high-born, sophisticated ways of the royal court. Wamara, the god-king whose royal court provides one setting for the action, is often associated with death.

The match between Lyanyaibungo and Mugasha is anti-romantic, based not in shared affection (as in the ballad *Kachwenyanja*) but in matchmaking as a discourse and an exchange between social groups. After the fisher-god's miraculous birth, which is formed in a remarkable 84-line poetic figure created by parallelisms, the themes point to equalities and inequalities and to comparison as a public act involving status and prestige. Examples of this kind of theme are legion, beginning with Mugasha's mother's sister's decision to accept Wamara's contract, and ending with the proverbial commentary in the last lines of the ballad. The bard's elaborate comparisons serve his wit, his social commentary, and his poetic creativity.

This recording of Habib's Mugasha (Mugasha I) was made in 1950 at the royal court of the then ruler of Kyamutwala kingdom, Gabriel Rugabandana, at Kabale, by Hugh Tracy, the renowned ethnomusicologist. In this otherwise remarkable and excellent performance, the singer truncates and illogically merges the two trials devised to reveal Mugasha's true mother. The missing text is provided in an Appendix, which reproduces the relevant passage from another recording of Habib made at the same place by Gabriel Rugabandana himself in 1980. The full text is included in the Haya Ballad Library as *Mugasha II* (1980). The two performances attest to Habib’s artistic achievement and the ways he elaborated and altered his art in 30 years of his career.

## Plot Outline

Lines 1-3.2:
Mugasha 1 begins with seventeen lines of poetic images that are associated with the fisher-god or that foreshadow the events of the ballad .

Lines 4-5.3:
Mugasha speaks from inside his mother's womb demanding birth but refusing to be born. The impossible birth torments his mother.

## Notes

1 Habib Suliman addresses the *Bahyoza*, the name for residents of the Kyamutwala kingdom, where the famous bard from Kiziba often performed. Lines 1-3 are praise names associated with Mugasha and other spirits. They are quoted from the spirits' self praise poetry (*ebyebugo*), which they recite with characteristic styles when they possess spirit mediums. Bards use and conserve this knowledge. Even though there is an organization of spirit mediums, the names and praises of spirits are not standardized. *Bitankwama*: possibly "These-(insulting words)-do-not-bother-me," a name that fits Mugasha's style. *Nyabuleza* and *Kashasila* are female spirits, whose relationship to childbearing is probably invoked here. *Never-envious* (of another's child), contrasts with Mugasha's aunt (l. 78ff.). *Ties up...* and *Thorns block the pathways* are images of difficult childbirth. Ishumi 1980 reports a new mother is traditionally congratulated "there are no thorns."

2.6 A *mugege* tree is used in medicine for vaginal bleeding; *engege* is menstral pain. The tree is also used to make charcoal for ironworking.

3 *Lwelu* is the Haya name for Lake Victoria/Nyanza, probably from *okw-ela,* "to be white" referring to the reflection of sunlight and sky in the water.

3.2 *Bull of the Tormentors-of-the-heart* signifies the strongest of the Bachwezi spirits, praise for Mugasha.

Bahyoza, Hear the Epic of *Bitankwama,*
*Little Feet of the Kafunzi Bird,*
*Nyabuleza, the Never Envious,*
*Kashasila, Restrains the First,*
*Thorns Block Pathways,*
.5 *The Wrathful,*
*Majambwe, Bull of the Heart-Tormenters,*
*Speaks from the Womb,*
*Comes from Mutoizi,*
*Brooks No Argument,*
*Water's Surge Smashes Everything,*
*Surges in the Flood,*
.5 *And as well*
*Surges in the Tree of Menstrual Pain,*
*Makes Bellows Breathe on Great Lake Lwelu.*
*He refused "I do not make my bellows breathe in town."*
*Go slowly, Majambwe, Bull of the Heart-Tormenters.*

That day I saw
He spoke to Nyambubi,
"Mother, push. Give me birth.
But fear, and I'll burst your side
*Brooks No Argument*."
5 Nyambubi pushed.
But it had no effect.
She rushed here and there.
Nyambubi was jerked into a frenzy.

Bahyoza hulila enanga ya *Bitankwama,*
*Ya Bugulu bwa Kafunzi,*
*Nyabuleza ka Techuba,*
*Kashasila Nkom' ekibanda,*
*Malinzi gait' emihanda,*
.5 *Lwa kyetabila,*
*Ngundu Majambwe Bashahila-mwoyo,*
*Kagambila-nda,*
*Aluga omwa Mutoizi,*
*Ekilema-ihanuula,*
*Lujagambya Lwanyakaata,*
*Ajagamby' omu ntunga,*
.5 *Ekya kabili*
*Ajagamby' omu ngege,*
*Ajugutil' omu nyanja empango nka Lwelu.*
*Akanga ahi, "Tindijugutil' omukyalo."*

*Wehunde majambwe engundu ya Bashahila-mwoyo.*

Omu kil' ekyo nkabona.
Yagambila Nyambubi,
Ati,"Mae sindikil' onzaile.
Kolatina ndakubalukila omu itundu
*Ekilema-ihanula."*
5 Nyambubi akasindikila.
Byabula nshai.
Yatel' oku n' oku.
Nyambubi yalamaijwa.

5.3 *Frenzy*: Mugasha's mother's state is like being jerked about in a lively dance.

## Poetic Stanzas

4-30.1: verse passage in **aabb** of four verses (**a**'s: 4-9.1, 10-18.1; **b**'s: 20-25.1, 26-30.1); verse passage **a**'s consist of verses formed in **aba** by mirror stanzas; in the first verse in **aba**, the pattern is formed by mirror stanzas (**a**'s: 4-5.3, 7-9.1) composed as address to Nyambubi (4-4.4,7-7.2) + near identical lines (5-5.3, 8-9.1) contrasted with lines that are not apparantly formed in a stanzaic pattern (**b**'s: 6-6.3); in the second verse in **aba**, the pattern is formed by mirror stanzas (**a**'s: 10-11.1, 15-18.1) composed as near identical lines (10-10.3, 15-15.3) + lines associated by incremental repetition (11-11.1, 18-18.1) contrasted with a passage (**b**: 12-14.1) punctuated by lines that create a pattern of **aab** (two linegroups, 12-12.2 and 12.3-13.1, ending markedly in *byabula nsha* "they had no effect" finalized by a linegroup, 14-14.1, which also finalizes the other stanzas in this section of the figure, cf. 11-11.1, 18-18.1); verse passage **b**'s consist of compound stanzas in **aab**; two compond stanzas in **aab** (20-23.2, 23.3-25.1) comprise the first **b** in the overall verse passage in **aabb**; the first of these compound stanzas is formed in **aab** by linegroups composed as initial subjunctive verb + preposition + name or praisename/ praisename (**a**'s: 20-20.5 and 21-22); the linegroup that completes the figure (**b**: 23-23.2) is itself formed in **aab** with lines that almost repeat the former composition, *locutive* + subjunctive + preposition + praisename/ praisename, but are finalized by a line (23.2) marked by an initial indicative verb that shifts quoted speech to narration; the second of the compound stanzas that comprise the first **b** in the overall verse passage in **aabb** is formed by linegroups composed as initial indicative narrative verb + preposition + name or praisename/ praisename (**a**'s: 23.3-23.5, 24-24.4) contrasted with a linegroup that completes the figure (**b**: 25-25.1) by echoing phrases deployed structurally elsewhere (11-11.1, 18-18.1); the compound stanza that comprises the second (continued on p. 2)

PLOT OUTLINE

Lines 6-18.1:
Midwives try various remedies, but none help.

NOTES

6.3 *Pretty Packet*, *Long necked* are praise for the midwife's appearance.

12.4 *Kin-of-the-Peaceful-one* is a praise name for women, people associated with Nyakalembe, "The Peaceful-one," a woman's agricultural spirit and the wife of Mugasha.

POETIC STANZAS

4-30.1 (continued from p.1) **b** in the overall verse passage in **aabb** is formed in **aa**a**b** by three line groups of quoted discourse, each introduced by a locutive (**a**'s: 27-27.2, 28-28.4, 29) contrasted with a linegroup (**b**: 30-30.1) of narrated responses to the orders and acts entailed in the previous linegroups; the second linegroup in this final pattern (28-28.4) is itself a compound stanza in **aab**, 2 + 2 + 1, formed by couplets composed as "cut" + treename/ "carve" + wooden utensil (**a**'s: 28-28.1, 28.2-28.3), contrasted with a single line (**b**: 28.4) that shares subjunctive verb initial syntax, but ends with a prepositional phrase rather than a direct object.

Those around her said, "Get midwives."
They brought Galengaine,
*Pretty packet, Long necked calabash from Mugunda.*
The healer picked Whitener and Benefactor
at the fence.

She spoke to Nyambubi
"My child, bear down. Give him birth.
The one who will end your childlessness is Mugasha."
On that day Nyambubi pushed.
But it had no effect.
She rushed here and there.
On that day, she was jerked into a frenzy.

10 On that day I saw.
The healer left the hearth room,
Her right hand holding as she came a hornful of tobacco.
Her left is busy too as one who makes *kilangi* extract.

The healer was confounded,
"What shall I do, my child?"

She said, "Bear down harder still."
They applied all the birthing medicines
But they had no effect.
The kind to lick and the kind to sniff,
The kind whose leaves they strip and throw in the hearth's flames,
.5 *The Kin of the Peaceful One.*

On that day they did them.
But they had no effect.
The healer was confounded,
"What shall I do my child?"

15 I saw her on that day
She left the hearth room,
Her right hand holding as she came a hornful of tobacco.
Her left is busy too as one who makes *kilangi* extract.

Ababaile bali 'ho bati, "Hondel' abazaza."
Baleta Galengaine,
*Mutana Lusheke owa Mugunda.*
Omukaikulu omu ilembo yagutul' olweza n' olugoshoola.

Yagambila Nyambubi
Ati, "Mwana wange gum' omuzale
Omwan' omo yakukumalila obugumba Mugasha."
Kil' ekyo Nyambubi akasindikila.
Byabula nshai.
Yatel' oku n' oku.
Kil' ekyo yalamaijwa.

10 Kil' ekyo nkabona.
Omukaikulu yaluga aha mwanya.
Mukono ogwa bulyo akaija akwete enyungu y' etaba.
Ogwa bumosho natagaita, nka akamula kilangi.

Omukaikulu yashobelwa,
Ati, "Ngilenta mwana wange?"

Ahi, "Wegumisilize."
Bataho enshamba zona
Byabula nshai.
Eyokulamba n' ogwokunukiliza,
Ogwokuhulutula mbanaga omu kyoto,

.5 *Abanyakalembe.*

Kil' ekyo bagila
Byabula nshai.
Omukaikulu yashobelwa,
Ati, "Ngilenta mwana wange?"

15 Nkabona kil' ekyo.
Yaluga aha mwanya.
Mukono ogwa bulyo akaija akwete enyungu y' etaba.
Ogwa bumosho natagaita nka akamula kilangi.

PLOT OUTLINE

Lines 19-25.1:
Finally, a midwife suggests consulting and sacrificing to Wamara, the king of gods.

NOTES

In lines 19-23 spiritual means are sought to birth Mugasha. Although Wamala assists in this, the high god's praise expresses semantic opposition to Mugasha. His swaying gate and *long neck, with rings of wrinkles* evoke the style and appearance associated with aristocracy, as Mugasha's style and appearance evoke the peasantry. Wamala is *set right by tribute* as a king, while Mugasha pumps his bellows (l. 3) as an artisan. Wamala's appetite for tribute is punningly proverbial: *Wamala tamalwa* "Wamala is never finished" (cited in Shmidt 1978). Wamala comes from the south, in Zinzaland, while Mugasha comes from the north in the Sesse Islands of Uganda. *Nyante* is Wamala's mother.

21 These praise names for Wamala are said to refer to serpents associated with him, who carry one another on their backs, as mothers do children.
Lines 24-30 detail the ritual preparations for Mugasha's birth, which construct and equip his spirit house, or shrine.

Lines 24-24.4 suggest that the bard augments Wamala's praisenames with those of other spirits. *Brother* (*Kinyanya,* l. 24) means literally, "sibling of the opposite sex" (i.e. not necessarily referring to a male) and *Arm that conquors* and *Embracer of Warriors* echo feminine praise in another context (*Rukiza* l. 97) and *Buttocks...* (l. 24.3) echos praise for the spirit of Rain (in the epic ballad *The Tree Mwata*. 212).

She said, "My powers!
My powers! My powers!"
On that day the healer stood confounded,
"What shall I do? My powers!"

We said, "Elder, what has happened?"
She said, "My children, hurry! Quickly, quickly!
Pray at a spirit shrine for help, my children.

20 Go to Wamara,
*Swaying One of Nyante,*
*Long of neck with rings of wrinkles,*
*Set Right by Tribute,*
*Tiny Egg of Endisa Bird,*
.5 *He came from Zinzaland.*
Pray to *He grows not weary when resolution is far off,*
*Tired in the back,*
*It carried those who don't drop down,*
*Relentless one,*
*Sheep of the White Region,* my children."
She said, "Go to *the Swaying One of Nyante,*
*Long of neck with rings of wrinkles*."
We took gray goats and white sheep.

On that day we brought tribute to Wamara,
*Swaying One of Nyante,*
.5 *Long of neck with rings of wrinkles.*
*Set Right by Tribute*
We brought tribute to the *Brother of the Hinda,*
*Arm that Conquers,*
*Embracer of Warriors,*
*Buttocks Filled with Sweet Banana Mash,*
*Sewing Awl.*
25 On that day the healer was confounded,
"What shall I do? My powers!"

I saw on that day
The *Swaying One of Nyante* said, "My children!"

Ati, "Amani gange!
Amani gange! Amani gange!"
Kil' ekyo omukaikulu yaikala ashobeilwe,
Ati "Ngilenta? Amani gange!"

Tuti, "Byaba bita mukaile?"
Ati, "Bana bange iluka bwangu bwangu!
Mutakile omu byanga bana bange.

20 Mugy' omwa Wamala,
*Luyongo lwa Nyante,*
*Kakyai Kagoobe,*
*Omugololwa-mpongano,*
*Ly' endisa,*
.5 *Akaluga Buzinja.*
*Muteege Talemwa bili halai,*
*Ndemwa mugongo,*
*Gwahekile abatatonye,*
*Lwanga kubonda,*
*Entama ya Bwela*, bana bange."
Ahi, "Mugy' omwa *Luyongo lwa Nyante,*
*Kakyai kagoobe."*
Twatwala ebisa n' ebitanga.

Kil' ekyo twabihonga omwa Wamala,
*Luyongo lwa Nyante,*
*.5* *Kakyai Kagoobe.*
*Omugololwa-mpongano*
Twabihonga omwa Kinyanya Abahinda(kazi*),*
*Mukono gwa kilema,*
*Afumbata emanzi,*
*Manyugunyu gajwile omulamba,*
*Mpindu ibazila.*
25 Kil' ekyo omukaikulu yashobelwa,
Ati, "Ngilenta? Amani gange!"

Nkabona kil' ekyo.
Luyongo lwa Nyante ahi, "Bana bange!"

PLOT OUTLINE

Lines 26-30.1:
Wamara instructs the petitioners [through a spirit medium] to build Mugasha a spirit shrine.

Lines 31-37.1:
Mugasha is born. He immediately sends his uncle on a journey to get him a lake canoe.

NOTES

27-29 Wamala speaks through a spirit medium. *Lwebembela* (l. 27.1), literally, "he-who-precedes," is Wamala's spirit helper and a guardian of the boundary betweeen Bachwezi and living mortals.

29 The *child fisherman* is Mugasha.

31 The miraculous child speaks at birth. One of Mugasha's names, *Nyatende* (31.1), is also that of his mother's sister. It refers to sheaves of crops, apropos of his association with fertility.

Lines 33 ff. suggest an episode developed more fully in a version from the southern part of Haya-land (Mulokozi 1987). The name of *Mugasha's mother's brother* can mean "provisions carried on a trip." The bard uses this to extend his name, creating a poetic figure: *Katanda Katahike, Food-for-the-road Never-arrives*. In the southern version, Katanda (without the second name) is identified with Mugasha's home, *Isheshe lya Katanda* "The Sesse Islands of Katanda." Mugasha journies there and defeats Katanda to reclaim his rightful kingdom before returning to marry the high god's daughter, which is the principal plot in all the Mugasha texts.

POETIC STANZAS

37-37.3: stanza in **abab** formed by contrast between lines that contain a double verb (**a**'s: 37, 37.2) and lines that begin with a single verb (**b**'s:37.1, 37.3).

He sent Harbinger, child of Kayango,
*By Misfortunes cursed*.
He said, "Go and fell a mushambya tree, the *Stretcherbearer*.
Carve from it small paddles nine.
Fell the *well-placed* mulinzi tree.
Carve from it a small canoe.
Put these in a spirit house,"
He said, "For *the child fisherman of Ishulaine Bugunda*."
30 The healer on that day brought them quickly, quickly.
They made the payment.

I saw
He was born, Nyatende. He came down.
He chanted his praise. He brought it from within.
He said, "Hurry to Kishanje of Kalasha at Mutailenge's
Go to Ibebe's at Bweza.
Go tell Uncle Food-for-the-road Never-arrives
He should hurry quickly, quickly
To Nyatende Mugasha."

Stop for tape change

He said, "Uncle Food-for-the-road Never-arrives
Run quickly, quickly
I would send you to Kiziba.
Go for me to Ntumwa Magembe at Nipelasho's in Kaigoma."
35 He said, "Have them transport for me a canoe of eight seats.
The ninth is horn."
They went and set it down at Nyakilembeka landing.
When they had set it down at Nyakilembeka landing–
I saw on that day–
He said, "Uncle, run quickly, quickly."

His uncle came and spoke to the child in his cradle.
He left.
The child went and he sat among the pillars of the antechamber.
He raised his hand.

Yasindika Lwebembela olwa Kayango,
Entegwa biyengo.
Ahi, "Mugye mutem' omushambya *omwinunula*.
Mubaije akagai mwenda.
Muteme omuteeko omulinzi.
Mubaije akato.
Mubite omu kikalo."
Ati, "*Omwana mujubi omwa Ishulaine Bugunda*."
30 Omukaikulu kil' ekyo yabileta bwangu bwangu.
Babihonga.

Nkabona
Yazalwa Nyatende. Yaija aha nsi.
Yebuga. Yekologota.
Ahi, "Iluka mugye Kishanje kya Kalasha omwa Mutailenge.
Mugye omwa Ibebe Bweza.
Mugende mugambile Menshaija Katanda Katahika
Ayanguhe bwangu bwangu
Nyatende Mugasha."

Stop for tape change

Ati, "Menshaija Katanda Katahika
Iluka bwangu bwangu
Nkutume Kiziba.
Ntumwa Magembe ongobele omwa Nipelasho Kaigoma."
35 Ahi, "Bagende bantwekele obwato bw' entebe munana.
Eihembe lya mwenda."
Bagenda babuhumuza omu mwalo Nyakilembeka.
Olwo bakabuhumwize omu mwalo Nyakilembeka -
Nkabona kil' ekyo -
Ati, "Menshaija, iluka bwangu bwangu."

Nyinalumi yagya yabimugambila omwana aha bulago.
Yalugaho.
Kagya kashuntama omu nyomyo z' omu ibanga.
Kaimuky' omukono.

I saw the Trapper on that day
When he had raised his hand,
I saw all the people were confounded.
He said, "Give to me my paddles nine, carved as I was being born."
They brought nine paddles.

He clutched one paddle.
He said, "This paddle's mine. I'll make a crossing."
He emerged into the forecourt,
They said, "He'll fall."
They saw him walking everywhere.

40 That day the child reached the cattle road.
His mother Nyambubi emerged that day as well.
She stood amazed.
People left the village.
They went ululating and singing,
Answering one another, the *Kin of the Peaceful One*
They sing, "The joyful one grows joyous."
They respond, "She grows joyous in her reign."

When they had walked with him to Nyakilembeka landing,
The child summoned Rushing Water of the Lake,
*Whirling Child of Limb-Twister*.
He said, "Whistling Wind *Blower-of-cold*, *I-never-miss-a-doorway*,
*Silent Runner* Lightning Flash."
He summoned Thunder.
He called the winged Nshungu wind of Lwabulungu,
*Great horns lie back across the shoulders,*
*Bad news brought by a traveler,*
*Puller-of-fish-lines*.

Nkabona kil' ekyo Njwenge.
Olwo yaimukiz' omukono
Nkabona abantu bona bashobelwa.
Ati, "Mp' engai zange ezobabaizile ninzalwa, engai mwenda."
Baleta engai mwenda.

Yakwata engai emoi,
Ati, "Engai yange. Ninshabula."
Yashohola omu kibuga,
Bati, "Kalagwa."
Babona kagendagenda.

40 Omwana kil' ekyo yagoba omu kihongolelo.
Nyambubi nyina yashohola kil' ekyo.
Yaikala ashobeilwe.
Abantu omu kyalo bahwayo.
Bagenda mbatel' empundu n' ebiina,
Nilwitika *Abanyakalembe*
Bati, "Kanyawela yela."
Bati, "Kayel' omu ngoma."

Kabamugobize omu mwalo Nyakilembeka,
Omwana yabilikila Mushoke gwa nyanja,
Izilinga lya nyakamyoka.
Ahi, "Kiwiwisi *Ekihutilizi-mbeho, Tinsiga-mulyango,*

*Kachwaichwaita* Kimyanso."
Abilikila Kaiyula.
Yayeta Nshungu kapapa ka Lwabulungu,
*Bikulembe bilalile mabega,*
*Nkulumbi etwalwa mugenzi,*
*Isika-migonjo*.

## Plot Outline

Lines 38-47:
The infant walks out to receive the assembled people and announces his intention to travel. All are amazed. Mugasha travels to Lake Victoria, where he summons the nature spirits he controls and announces his intentions to catch fish.

## Notes

37.4 *Trapper* (of fish) is a praise name for Mugasha.

40 A *cattle road* is located at least 30-40 yards from a dwelling, at the end of a forecourt. It is wider than a footpath.

41 *Kin-of-the-Peaceful-One* are women (12n). "*The joyful one grows joyous...*" are words of a women's song at weddings.

43 *Silent runner* praises lightning, which in traditional belief is silent and relatively harmless; thunder is thought to make noise and do damage.

44 *Nshungu* is a strong seasonal wind that brings cloud formations resembling the long horns of Ankole cattle.

## Poetic Stanzas

38-38.3: stanza in **abab** formed by contrast between lines that describe an action by mugasha (**a**'s: 38, 38.2) and those that describe a reaction by others (**b**'s: 38.1, 38.3).

39-39.4: compound stanza in **aab**, 2 + 2 + 1, formed by couplets (**a**'s: 39-39.1, 39.2-39.3) composed as 3rd sing verb initial/ direct quotation introduced by locutive contrasted with a single line that begins with a 3rd plural verb (**b**: 39.4).

40-40.2: stanza in **aab** formed by contrast between lines composed as subject + "that day" + verb (order reverses) (**a**'s: 40-40.1) and one line composed only of two verbs (**b**: 40.2).

41-41.4: compound stanza in **abb**, 1 + 2 + 2, formed by couplets that cohere by verb initial and locutive initial syntax, respectively (**b**'s: 41.1-41.2, 41.3-41.4) contrasted with a single subject initial line (**a**: 41).

42.1-44.3: stanza in **ab**bb**aa**b**b**b formed by contrast between lines: composed as [child] + calls + spiritname (**a**'s: 42.1, 43.2, 44); and lines composed as praise-name alone (**b**'s: 42.2, 43, 43.1, 44.1, 44.2, 44.3).

### Plot Outline

Lines 48-50:
He sets out on the lake, but his mother prays to the Sun for his return, and he returns to shore.

Lines 51-54.1:
Mugasha lives on the lake for eight years and in the ninth decides to visit his mother.

### Notes

45.1 A *forgetful debtor* avoids looking his creditor in the eye.

46 *Empala* is a type of catfish whose whiskers swing about like the long horns of an aggressive bull.

49 Mugasha's mother invokes the *Sun* in two personas: as the shining heavenly body and as the child of the Creator, Nyamuhanga.

49.1 The emergence of *the upper teeth* of an infant before the lower is understood as an extremely unfortunate sign. It becomes an image for any grave misfortune that may befall a child and its mother.

57 I have substituted the word "Trapper" for *omukaikulu*, which means "elder woman" (referring to the midwife) and which is apparantly a mistake here.

### Poetic Stanzas

45-46.2: compound stanza in **aab**, 2 + 2 + 2, formed by contrast between couplets composed as double verb/ 0verb (**a**'s: 45-45.1, 45.2 -46) and a couplet that coheres by repetition of "I'll catch" in intital position (**b**: 46.1-46.2).

48-50: verse in **aba**, 1 + 4 + 1, formed by single lines that begin "I saw" + "canoe": (**a**'s: 48, 50) contrasted with four lines (**b**: 48.1-49.1) that form a stanza in **aa**a**b** by contrast between lines with 3rd person near past verbs in (near) initial position (**a**'s: 48.1-49) and a single line of quoted speech beginning with a locutive.

45 He said, "This very day I'm wanting to be traveling.
This day on Great Lake Lweru,
I would go and fish *enkuyu*, *Big eyes skyward like a forgetful debtor*."
He said, "Empala fish, the *Long-horn enkoma mujungwizi*,
I'll catch this very day.
I'll catch *bukeije* and *bukokalongo*."

I saw the Trapper on that day.

I saw his canoe float out into the middle of the lake.
His mother Nyambubi clapped her hands.
She spread her palms.
She summoned the Sun *I-have-shone* and the Sun *He-who-creates*.
She said, "My child roams, and I await what comes like upper teeth."
50 I saw The canoe came back to Nyakilembeka landing.

Out in the middle of the lake Mugasha spent eight years.
In the ninth he summoned Rushing Water.
He said, "*Lake-dweller, Puller-of-fish-lines,* I'm wanting

I would go to where I first set out,
I would travel and see my mother, who gave birth to me,
I would see her, who pushed for me."
When they had paddled on that day, the Trapper,
He said, "I would go and see my mother, who gave birth to me.
I would see her, who pushed for me."

55 From out in the middle he saw nine women.
They were drawing water at Nyakilembeka landing.
He said, "Among those women
I cannot tell the one who gave birth to me.
I cannot tell the one who pushed for me, Mugasha."
He was confounded on that day, the Trapper.

52.1-54.1 compound stanza in **ab-ab**, 1 + 2 + 1 + 2, formed by contrast between couplets that essentially repeat (**b**'s: 52.2-52.3, 54-54.1) and single lines (**a**'s: 52.1, 53).

45 Ahi, "Kilo ekya mbwenu ningonza ninkyalile.
Kil' eki omu nyanja mpango nka Lwelu,
Ngende njube enkuyu, Bilali bya kahunga."

Ati, "Empala, Luhembe enkoma mujungwizi,
Nyite kilo ekya mbwenu.
Nyite obukeije n' obukokalongo."

Nkabona kil' ekyo Njwenge.

Nkabona obwato bwailila obuziba.
Nyambubi nyina yatela omu mikono.
Yayala ebiganja.
Yabilikila Kazoba aka *Ntangaile* na Kazoba aka *Nyamuhanga*.
Ahi, "Kai omwana nagenda, ndategela ekilija amaino ga lugulu."
50 Nkabona obwato bwaluga omu mwalo Nyakilembeka.

Mugasha obuziba akamalayo ebyanda munana.
Ekya mwenda yabilika Mushoke.
Ahi, "*Gwa nyanja, Isika-migonjo* ningonza

Ngobe mbali nsaabile,
Ngende mbone mawe ayanzaile,

Mbone ayansindikiile."
Olwo bakabukile kil' ekyo, Njwenge,
Ahi, "Ngye mbone mawe ayanzaile.
Mbone ayansindikiile."

55 Akema obuziba yabona abakazi mwenda.
Mbataha amaizi omu mwalo Nyakilembeka.
Ati, "Aha abakazi abo,
Tinkumanya ayanzaile.
Tinakumanya ayansindikiile, Mugasha."
Yashobelwa kil' ekyo omukaikulu.

56-57.1: compound stanza in **abb**, 1 + 2 + 2, formed by contrast between couplets that cohere by parallelism and repetition (**b**'s: 56.1-56.2, 57-57.1) and a single line that begins with a locutive (**a**: 56).

He sat there confounded.
When he saw the nine women,

He made a man's plan.
He jumped from the canoe.
He threw himself into the lake, Mugasha.
He threw out his arm.
He called, "Come grab hold, save me! The water is swallowing me!"
That day they were confounded.

60 I saw The women all fell into a quandry.
Mugasha's aunt said, "Let me impale Mugasha. I'll kill him.
They'll give me nine children.
These cannot be outweighed by Nyambubi's single child ."

When she raised the spear, Nyambubi grabbed her from below.
She said, "This thing won't kill my child for me!
It wasn't I who brought its childlessness."
That day he was astonished, *Majambwe the Trapper*.
I saw those present
Said, "Nyambubi, you win the case.
There is no woman who'd kill the child she bore.
Nyambubi, the child is yours."
They gave her an *enkuyu* fish, *Big eyes skyward like a forgetful debtor*.
65 They said, "Mother's sisters should not leave empty handed."
I saw them give her *bukeije* and *bukena* minnows.

On that day, Nyatende,
*Trapper,*
*Water-dweller,*
Mugasha.

Yaikala ashobeilwe.
Olwo yaboine abakazi mwenda,

Yakola magezi ga bashaija.
Yaluga omu bwato.
Yenaga omu nyanja Mugasha.
Yanag' omukono.
Ati, "Mwije munkwate. Amaizi gandya!"

Kil' ekyo bashobelwa.

60 Nkabona abakazi bona bagwa omu bitangalo.
Nyinento Mugasha ahi, "Kanchumite Mugasha, mwite.
Balampa abana mwenda.
Tibalikwigana mwan' omoi wa Nyambubi."

Kayalyetwekile Nyambubi yaluga aha nsi yamukwata.

Ahi, "Kitanyitila mwana!
Tinye nakileteile bugumba."
Kil' ekyo yashobelwa Majambwe Njwenge.
Nkabona ababaile bali 'ho
Bati, "Nyambubi nosinga omushango.
Taliho mukazi alaisile mwana amuzaile.
Nyambubi, omwana wawe."
Bamuha enkuyu, *Bilali bya kahunga*.

65 Bahi, "Banyinento muntu tibalugaho busha."

Nkabona bamuha obukeije n' obukena.

Kil' ekyo Nyatende,
Njwenge,
Ky' omu maizi,
Mugasha.

### Plot Outline

Lines 55-59.2:
On the shore he sees nine women, but he cannot tell which is his mother. He feigns drowning so his mother will reveal herself by saving him.

Line 60
The bard apparently combines similar episodes by mistake. In the missing passage, Mugasha's mother's sister at this point in the narrative runs into the lake to save him but then fearfully retreats, leaving Mugasha's question unanswered. Then Wamara proposes another test: To whoever takes Kagoro's copper spear and kills Mugasha, Wamara will grant nine children. The bard's performance of these events can be found in the Appendix (pages 18-19), copied from his 1980 performance.

Lines 60.1-66.3:
Mugasha's mother's sister reasons that nine children outweigh one and takes the spear to kill Mugasha, but she is prevented from doing so by Nyambubi, Mugasha's mother. Nyambubi thus reveals her maternal identity and wins the trial.

### Notes

59 Mugasha's being *swallowed by the water* is a laughable ruse, for he is the spirit that controls its power.

### Poetic Stanzas

58.1-59.1 stanza in **aa**aaa**b**, formed by contrast between lines that begin with 3rd person near-past (**a**'s: 58.1-59) and a single line of quoted speech that begins with a locutive.

63.1-65.1 stanza in **a**aa**bab** formed by contrast between lines (or a linegroup) that begins with a locutive and contains an ethical judgement (**a**'s: 63.1-63.3, 65) and lines composed as "they gave her" + fish name (**b**'s: 64, 65.1).

PLOT OUTLINE

Lines 67-86.2: The Call
Mugasha returns to the lake and one day sees Wamara's daughter gathering straw. He proposes to her but she rejects him. He swears he will marry her; she swears he will not.

NOTES

68 *Nyatende* refers to Mugasha.

70.2 *Bull* denotes leadership and preeminence and is used in praise of the maiden; she is the most pleasing among maidens, like deep red wild figs, *the kalaito* fruit. Her stature is parallel and opposed to that of Mugasha, who is called the Bull of the Torment-ers-of-the-Heart; first among the Bachwezi spirits of possession ( 1.6).

70.4-70.6 praise of the god Wamala, see notes to 19-23.

71ff. Lyanyaibungo was gathering straw to place on the floor of a dwelling. Work of this kind comes under the category of "to make things pleasing" a knowledge especially associated with marriagable young women.

POETIC STANZAS

70-71.2: compound stanza in **aba**, 3 + 4 + 3, formed by contrast between number sequences (**a**'s: 70 -70.2, 71-71.2) and lines that refer to Wamala (**b**'s: 70.3-70.6).

72-74.2: compound stanza in **aab**, 3 + 3 + 3, by virtue of contrast between lines of narration of the wind's attack (**a**'s: 72-72.2, 73-73.2) and those that describe the daughter's defeat and speech (**b**'s: 74-74.2)

Stop for tape change

When he had found the mother who had borne him,
*the Trapper*,
He returned to Great Lake Lweru.
He took hold of his canoe.
He passed by Kishanje village of Kalasha at
Mutailenge's house.
He alighted at the home of Ibebe at Bweza.
.5 I saw he passed Rubafu at the waters of Nyamataba.

At Kanyabagwa beach, Nyatende, the Trapper.
I saw he passed Kyahu island of Nyakwezi.
He cast his eyes towards Bitterness Marsh, Mugasha.

70 That was when he saw eight maidens.
The ninth was Lwanyaibungo,
*Bull of the Pretty Kalaito*.
The maiden was the daughter of Wamara,
*Swaying One of Nyante,*
.5 *Long of Neck with Rings of Wrinkles,*
*Set Right by Tribute*.
She'd gathered straw four and four, eight bundles;
The ninth she clutched in her hand;
The tenth she pressed underfoot.

The child was surprised by Whistling Wind,
*Blower-of-cold, I-never-miss-a-doorway*.
That straw, the Wind strewed and strewed about.
She pressed and pressed it together with her skirt.
But it had no effect.
She sat down on the ground.
She swore, "O father!
*Swaying One of Nyante*."
75 The maiden on that day was confounded.

Her companions ran, they left her.
She sat there confounded.

She'd not gotten the words out of her mouth
When suddenly Nyatende appeared,

Stop for tape change

Olwo yakasigile yabona nyina alikumuzala, Njwenge,

Yashuba omu nyanja mpango nka Lwelu.
Yakwata obwato.
Yezinga Kishanje kya Kalasha omwa Mutailenge.

Yatonya omwa Ibebe Bweza.
.5 Nkabona yezinga Rubafu omuga Nyamataba.

Aha munwa gwa Kanyabagwa, Nyatende Njwenge.
Nkabona yezinga Kyahu kya Nyakwezi.
Yanaga amaisho omu izinga Bushungu, Mugasha.

70 Nilwo yaboine abaisiki munana.
Owa mwenda akaba ali Lwanyaibungo,
Engundu y' akakalaito.
Omwisiki ogwo abali muhala wa Wamala,
Luyongo lwa Nyante,
.5 Kakyai Kagobe,
Omugolowa mpongano.
Akaba yaiya obunyasi emiganda ena munana;
Ogwa mwenda agukwete omu byala;
Ogwa ikumi akashangwa agulibatile.

Omwana akechula Kiwiwisi,
*Ekihutilizi-mbeho, Tinsiga mulyango*
Obunyasi omuyaga gwabunaganaga.
Yabumbabumba n' akashenshe
Byabula nshai.
Yashuntama aha nsi.
Yanahila ati, "Iwe tata!
*Luyongo lwa Nyante*."
75 Omwisiki kil' ekyo yashobelwa.

Batahibe bailuka bamusiga.
Yaikala ashobeilwe.

Akaba atakakihil' omu kanwa
Lyamuleeta Nyatende,

*Bull of the Heart-Tormentors.*
*Speaker from the Womb,*
*Comes from Mutoizi,*
*Brooks No Argument.*
He said, *"I am the only child.*
*I ended my mother's childlessness."*
"Maiden, I would court you, I would marry you."
The maiden on that day sat there confounded.

I saw
She said, "You are not one to marry me,
Little fisherman of Ishulaine Bugunda."
80 She said, "Die without issue! You stink!"
That day Mugasha had tied on his cloak of dried minnows.
I saw on that day.
The maiden spat.
Spittle scattered.
She said, "I swear to you Mugasha
Rather than have you marry me
.5 I'd sleep with my mother's child, Kagolo."
She said, *"Of the Spirit Shrine,*
*Of the Water Oracle,*
*Missile of Despair,*
*Speaker of Angry, Dry Words,*
*With Stiffened Elbows."*
She said, *"Adorned with beads all over except the palm,*
*Of the Left-handers,*
*Of the Water Oracle."*
The maiden on that day sat confounded.

85 I saw on that day
He spoke, Nyatende,
*Little Feet of the Kafunzi Bird.*
He said, "Maiden, this very day
If I should fail to marry you
I'd lie with my own mother, Nyambubi."

*Ngundu ya Bashahila-mwoyo.*
*Kagambila-nda,*
*Naluga omwa Mutoizi,*
*Ekilema-ihanuula.*
Ahi, *"Inye ndi mwana omoi.*
*Nkamalila mawe obugumba.*
*Mwisiki nkushelele nkushwele."*
Omwisiki kil' ekyo akaikala ashobeilwe.

Nkabona.
Ahi, "Toina kunshwela,
Akajubu k' omwa Ishulaine Bugunda."
80 Ahi, "Chwekamu! Nonuka!"
Kil' ekyo Mugasha akaba ashumukile ebeebo y' obukanda.
Nkabona kil' ekyo.
Omwisiki yachw' enyili.
Zatalaka.
Ahi, "Nkwenahilile Mugasha
Nangu kawakunshwela,
.5 Ninkanyiame n' omwana wa mawe, Kagolo."
Ati, "*Akomu lwanga,*
*Ka Byantabuzi,*
*Luhuba lwa kachubya,*
*Butoto bwa Kyomya,*
*Nkokola zabaile igandami."*
Ahi, *"Buhunzile bwona busigaize akaganja,*
*Bwa nyin' emosho,*
*Ka Byantabuzi."*
Omwisiki kil' ekyo yaikala ashobeilwe.

85 Nkabona kil' ekyo.
Nagamba Nyatende,
*Bugulu bwa Kafunzi.*
Ahi, "Mwisiki, kilo ekya mbenu,
Kanakuba ntakushweile,
Ninkalale na mawe, Nyambubi."

NOTES

81.5 *Mother's child* is a way of referring to one's sibling (here, a brother) that connotes affection.

82-83.2. Kagolo's praise alludes to his hot-headed and warlike behavior, which spirit mediums embody when they are possessed by him.

82.3 *Dry words* are strong and effective, as opposed to wet' words, which are weak.

82.4 *Stiff Elbows* probably reflects his demeanor as a possessing spirit; it seems to reinforce in gestural language his extreme and immoderate behavior.

83.2 *The water oracle* (*Byantabuzi*) is associated with this spirit (its name comes from *oku-tabula,* "to make water bubble up or forth"). Byantabuzi also echoes the name of the place where Kagolo acquired his characteristic way of talking (l. 136.3).

POETIC STANZAS

79-80.2: stanza in annular structure - **abcba** - by contrast between lines composed as aside (in distant past tense)/ locutive + 2nd person/ 0verb descriptor/ locutive + 2nd person/ aside.

81-86.2: verse in **aba** formed by mirror stanzas (**a**'s: 81-81.5, 85-86.2) composed as formulaic aside (81, 86)/ communicative act described (81.1-2, 85.1-.2)/ address (81.3, 86)/ statement involving marriage, inflected as contrary -to-fact (81.4, 86.1)/ vowed incest (81.5, 86.2) contrasted with lines composed as praise/ formulaic line (**b**'s: 82-84).

73-84: repeated line (75, 76.1, 78.4 and 84) finalizes passages of the winds' appearance, the girls' desertion, Mugasha's proposal and Lyanyaibungo's reply

86.3-87.3: compound stanza in **abb**, 1 + 2 + 2, formed by contrast between couplets (**a**'s: 87-87.1, 87.2-87.3) each indtroduced by a locutive, and cohering respectively by enjambment (name/ praise-name) parallelism (initial 2nd person subjunctive).

PLOT OUTLINE

Lines 87-102.1:
Mugasha summons his minions. They attend him, identify themselves with their praise epithets, and promise to assist Mugasha in his marriage plan.

NOTES

187.3 *They-die-but-they've-been-told* is the name of Mugasha's drum.

189.1ff *Roaring* here translates *ngu*, a conjunction sometimes used to introduce indirect discourse. Here it seems onomotopoetic.

92.4 For *Long horn* see 46n.

95 *Ensenene grasshoppers* are caught, dressed, cooked, and eaten as a great delicacy that comes once a year, during the short rainy season. They are usually caught singly with the hand. The tasty grasshopper boasts that there will be so many as to be scooped up in large baskets.

POETIC STANZAS

88-91.1: compound stanza in **ab-ab**ab formed between lines composed as praisename final (**a**'s: 88, 90, 91) and those that represent drum sound (**b**'s: 88.1-.2, 89-89.1, 90.1-.2, 91.1).

91.2-102.1: verse passage formed by repeated sequences of three types of lines: [verb of entry or appearance] + animal name (91.2, 92, 92.3, 93, 94, 95, 97, 99.1, 99.3, 100.1, 101.2)/ praisenames of animal (91.3, 92.4, 93.1-.2, 95.1-96.1, 99.2, 102-102.1)/ locutive + "you marry her, Mugasha"

He summoned Rushing Water.
He said, "Rushing Water of the Lake,
*Whirling Child of Limb-Twister,"*
He said, "Go inside the Mugoma rocky outcrop.
Sound my great drum– They-die
But-they've-been-told."

He went and sounded They-die But-they've-been-told,
Roaring Di-di-di,
Roaring De-de-de.
Roaring Di-di-di,
Roaring De-de-de.
90 I saw that day They-die But-they've-been-told,
Roaring Di-di-di,
Roaring De-de-de.
I saw it speak, They-die But-they've-been-told,
Roaring Di-di-di.

There attended on that day *nkuyu* fish,
*Big eyes skyward like a forgetful debtor.*
It said, "You marry her, Mugasha!"
There attended catfish.
It said, "You marry her, Mugasha!"
I saw on that day.
I saw the *empala* fish,
*Long-horn enkoma mujungwizi.*
.5 It said, "You marry her, Trapper!"
Hippopotamus
*Smasher of Long Canoes*
*Old Man of the Waves,*
It said, "You marry her, Mugasha!"
I saw frogs and *bukena* minnows
Saying, "You marry her, Trapper!"

95 Up and spoke the *nsenene* grasshopper.
It said, *"I am Lwakyenge and Lagaza*
*My head is a thin straw; my foot is njulujunga.*
*I'll fall four and four, eight days in Kyamutwala.*
*The ninth will be a time for bushel baskets.*
You marry her, Trapper!"

Yabilika Mushoke.
Ati, "Mushoke gwa nyanja,
*Izilinga lya nyakamyoka,"*
Ati, "Ogende omu kyazi ekya Mugoma.
Ogy' otagalule engoma yange mpango - Bafa
Bagambilwe."

Yagya yagitagalula Bafa Bagambilwe,
Ngu Di-di-di
Ngu De-de-de.
Ngu Di-di-di,
Ngu De-de-de.
90 Nkabona kil' ekyo Bafa Bagambilwe,
Ngu Di-di-di,
Ngu De-de-de.
Nkabona yalaha Bafa Bagambilwe,
Ngu Di-di-di.

Lyahulula kil' ekyo Nkuyu,
*Bulali bya kahunga.*
Ati, "Nomushwela Mugasha!"
Yahulula Enshonzi.
Eti, "Nomushela Mugasha!"
Nkabona kil' ekyo.
Nkabona empala.
*Luhembe enkoma mujungwizi.*
.5 Eti, "Nomushwela Njwenge!"
Enjubu,
*Kyata mato,*
*Mukulu w' amayengo,*
Eti, "Nomushwela Mugasha!"
Nkabona Ebikele n' Obukena.
Biti, "Nomushwela Njwenge!"

95 Yaimuka yagamba Nsenene,
Ati, "*Ndi Lwakyenge na Lagaza*
*Akatwe misheke; akagulu njulujunga.*
*"Ndagwa ebilo binai na bina munana Kyamutwala*
*Ekya mwenda kulaba kuhunga.*
Nomushwela Njwenge!"

PLOT OUTLINE

Lines 103-106.3
Mugasha asks them about the items of brideprice and other gifts needed for a wedding, and he makes substitutions for them with lake animals.

NOTES

98.1 "*Where could we go…?*" is a question that speaks to the virtue and shame invested in the events. The lowly fisherman acts on behalf of many

103.3-106.3 *Cattle* are used for brideprice. A *white sheep* is usually to be sacrificed to a clan spirit. *Butterfat* is spread on a bride to make her shine with beauty. A bride's mother's sister receives a *gift* also, as was alluded to above (65).

POETIC STANZAS

103.3-106.1: two verse passages formed by Mugasha's general questions about brideprice and wedding gifts, respectively (103.3 and 104) and answers and Mugasha's substitutions composed in pairs as locutive + answer/ locutive + substitution (103.4-103.5, 103.6-103.7 and 104.1-104.2, 104.3-104.4, 105.1-105.2, 105.4-105.5, 106-106.1); note interpolated formulaic lines (105 and 105.3) and finalizing repetition of "confounded" (106.3).

Thunder, *Essential Warrior*,
He said, "You marry her Mugasha!"
He said, "If you didn't marry Lyanyaibungo, Mugasha,
Where could we go, Trapper?"
I saw on that day.
He was confounded, Mugasha.

I saw on that day.
He looked at the *empala* fish,
*Long-horn enkoma mujungwizi,*
And at *bukena* minnows.
100 I saw on that day
The *enkolongo* fish as well,
It said, "You marry her, Mugasha!"
I saw on that day.
Up spoke the locust,
He said, "*I am the sharpening stone,*
*Lover of the Mountain Pass*."

Stop for tape change

On that day I saw.
He asked them . . .
I saw on that day . . .

He said, "You who've come, tell me– to marry at the *Swaying One of Nyante's*, what kind of brideprice do they give?"
That day they told him.
.5 "They give cattle, my lord."
He said, "Take hippopotami."
They said, "But my friend, what about sheep?"
He said, "Take crocodiles."
On that day, Mugasha.

I saw him say, "But my friends, what else do they do?"
That day they said, "Butterfat for the bride."
He said, "Take *bukena* minnow scales. Fill a snail shell with them."
They said, "Bring a bedsheet for the mother's sister."
He said, "Strings of dried *bukanda* fish."

Nkuba *Kanyalumanzi*
Ati, "Nomushwela Mugasha!"
Ati, "Otashwele Lyanyaibungo, Mugasha,
Twakugy' ahai Njwenge?"
Nkabona kil' ekyo.
Yashobelwa Mugasha.

Nkabona kil' ekyo.
Yaleba Empala,
*Luhembe enkoma mujungwizi*,
N' obukena.
100 Nkabona kil' ekyo.
N' Enkolongo,
Eti, "Nomushwela Mugasha!"
Nkabona kil' ekyo.
Yaimuka yagamba Nzige,
Ahi, "*Inye ndi lwa kamahyolo,*
*Lugonza empalo*…"

Stop for tape change

Kil' ekyo nkabona.
Yababaza ati...
Nkabona kil' ekyo

Ati, "Inywe abaija kushwela omwa Luyongo lwa Nyante, bajugaki?"

Kil' ekyo bamugambila bati,
.5 "Waitu, bajuga ente."
Ahi, "Mutwale Enjubu."
Bati, "Bojo si, embuzi y' Entama?
Ahi, "Mukwate Enshambi."
Kil' ekyo Mugasha.

Nkabona ati, "Bojo si, mbagile' ntai?"
Kil' ekyo bati, "Amajuta g' omugole."
Ahi, "Mukwate amakamba g' obukena. Mwijuze akashogoto."
Bati, "Twal' eishuka lya nyinento."
Ati, "Ekitundu ky' obukanda."

### Plot Outline

Lines 107-113.3.
At Wamara's palace, a party of lake dwellers arrives to arrange a marriage. Wamara rejects the suit, and with his power alters the appearance of several of the animals who attend

### Notes

106.4 The *frog's song* and the events it alludes to apparantly come from a folktale, but I have not been able to find the one.

110.1 On the day before a bride leaves home to live with her husband's family, an elder representative of the husband's clan comes bearing a spear to make a speech. The fish who performs this act here is a kind of catfish, whose spear Wamara fused to his back.

111 The *maiden of the hafted knife* is a young girl who accompanies the speech-making, spear-bearing elder. Her cultural butterfat becomes natural slime by the power of Wamala.

113.3 *Drink it at the spearshaft of Ndekezi* is a proverbial expression for committing suicide. The phrase refers to a poison ordeal administered by a medium of the spirit Kimuli.

### Poetic Stanzas

110-112.2: verse passage in **aba**, 3 + 3 + 3, formed by three triplets each composed as animal substitution/ attribute of wedding role/ permanent attribute of animal; first and third triplets are essentially the same.

113-114.8: verse passage in **aba**, 4 + 4 + 5, formed by linegroups (**a**'s: 113-113.3, 114.4-114.8) composed as I saw + that day + [name]/ praisemane/ locutive + 2 or 3 lines that first enunciate refusal (113.2-.3) then acceptance (114.6-.8), contrasted with an intervening linegroup (**b**: 114-114.3) that is internally formed as **aba** by contrast between lines composed as "he sent" + direct object (**a**'s: 114, 114.3) and lines that are formulaic repetitions (**b**'s:114.1, 114.2).

105 I saw that day.
They said, "Iron pruning tools?"
He said, "Bring tilapia."
I saw that day, Mugasha.
They said, "Cattle?"
.5 He said, "Bring hippopotami."
They said, "A sheep?"
He said, "Take a crocodile."

That day he sat confounded, Nyatende
*Bull of the Heart-Tormenters*.

That day, the *Swaying One of Nyante* was
surprised by frogs, jumping and jumping.
.5 They sang, "They'll tell of this."
They said, "They'll tell of this.
They'll tell of this.
They'll tell of this."
They said, "What did I say to you, Father Grunter?
I said, 'Free me from a trap and I'll free you.'
What did I tell you my blood brother?
I said, 'Free me from a trap and I'll free you.'"

110 That day when I looked into the reception room,
I found the *enkolongo* making a wedding speech.
The spear that *enkolongo* held on his shoulder,

Is the spike that's now stuck on his back.
The maiden of the hafted knife was a catfish.
She'd spread on so much butterfat for sleekness
That today to grasp a catfish, you first must pat
some mud.
The elder who made the courting speech was *enkonlongo*.
The spear he held on his shoulder,
Is the spike that's now stuck on his back.

I saw on that day
*The Swaying One of Nyante*
He said, "Before I'd give a daughter to Mugasha,
I'd drink from the spear of Ndekezi."
He sent all these things.

105 Nkabona kil' ekyo.
Bati, "Ebihosho?"
Ahi, "Mutwale ebigege."
Nkabona kil' ekyo, Mugasha.
Bati, "Ente?"
.5 Ati, "Mutwale enjubu."
Bati, "Embuzi y' entama?"
Ahi, "Mukwate enshambi."

Kil' ekyo yaikala ashobeilwe, Nyatende
*Engundu ya bashahila mwoyo*.

Kil' ekyo *Luyongo lwa Nyante* akechula ebikele,
mbichokachoka.
.5 Bikwete, "Balikagana."
Biti, "Balikagana
Balikagana
Balikagana."
Biti, "Nkakugambilaki Ishe Lukimbila?
Nti, 'Ntegulula ndikutegulula.'
Nkakugambilaki munywani wange?
Nti, 'Ntegulula ndikutegulula.'"

110 Kil' ekyo kanagile kuleba omu ibanga,
Nkashanga enkolongo netela omushango.
Nkolongo eichumu 'lyoyabaile ataile aha ibega,

Nilyo ihwa lyagikwete aha mugongo.
Omwisiki w' omuholo akaba ali nshonzi.
Amajuta 'gayabaile ayesigile okutelela,
Na mambwenu koija kukwat' enshonzi, okalakal'
akashabo.
Omugulusi w' okutela omushango akaba ali Nkolongo.
Eichumu 'lyoyabaile ataile aha ibega
Nilyo ihwa 'lyagikwete aha mugongo.

Nkabona kil' ekyo
Luyongo lwa Nyante
Ahi, "Kanakusigila Mugasha,
Nakuganywa aha lubango lwa Ndekezi."
Yasindikila ebintu byona

PLOT OUTLINE

Lines 114-114.8.
Mugasha then sends a hailstorm, and Wamara agrees, handing over his daughter to the wedding party

Lines 115-121
The party meets Mugasha at the shore and hands Wamara's daughter over; Mugasha worries about Kagoro.

Lines 122-125.3
Mugasha returns to the lake with Wamara's daughter, while at Wamara's palace, Kagoro returns, inquires what happened, equips himself with bow and arrows, and goes to find the daughter.

NOTES

114.8 *The bull of Nyambubi* refers to Mugasha.

117-120.3 These lines are spoken in a rapid recitative. *Welata* is supposed to be a word in the Ganda language. Mugasha speaks Haya with a Ganda accent and uses some Ganda vocabulary, because comes from the north, from the Sesse Islands of Uganda in Lake Victoria/Nyanza. Mugasha takes his bride home and stays inside with her for eight days. Then her brother Kagolo returns. He arms himself and goes to fight Mugasha.

121 These vocables are sung in the melody of a fisherman's paddling song.

122 See note to 82 for Kagoro's praise

POETIC STANZAS

122-122.7: stanza in **aabb**bbbb formed by a couplet and a longer line-group that cohere, respectively, by parallelism (3 verb figure) and enjambment (name / praisenames...).

But they had no effect.
I saw Mugasha on that day
He sent Hailstones, child of Earthquake.
On that day I saw Wamara,
.5 *Swaying One of Nyante*
He said, "Give her to him.
Let her go and marry him,
The bull of Nyambubi."
115 When they handed her over to them,
They set her down on Nyakilembeka landing.
There they met Nyatende Mugasha.
*Spoken*
He said, "And you, welata,
Rushing Water of the Lake, *(Puller)-of-fish-lines*,"
He said, "*Whirling Kamengo of Limb-Twister Kabantende*,

I welcome you from your journey, welata."
They said, "Indeed."

He said, "And when you got there, did you meet Kagolo,

*Of the Spirit Shrine,*
*Of the Water Oracle*, Welata?"
120 They said, "We did not meet him there, my lord."
He said, "Paddle swiftly!
Don't you know Kagolo's coming to churn the lake up,
With the children still in the middle, Welata?"

*Return to singing*
Ya-ya Ya-ya Ya-ya Ya-ya Ya-ya Ya-ya

He went and he married her.
He stayed inside with her four and four, eight days.
Then suddenly appeared (at Wamara's palace)–
Kagolo,
*Of the Spirit Shrine,*
*Of the Water Oracle,*
5 *Missile of Despair,*
*Speaker of Angry, Dry Words,*
*With Stiffened Elbows.*

Byabula nshai.
Nkabona Mugasha kil' ekyo.
Yasindika Lubale olwa Misisi.
Kil' ekyo nkabona Wamala,
.5 *Luyongo lwa Nyante*
Ahi, "Mumuhe.
Agye amushwele,
Engundu ya Nyambubi."
115 Olwo bakamuheleza,
Bamuhumuza omu mwalo Nyakilembeka.
Bamushangaho Nyatende Mugasha.
Spoken
Ati, "Na iwe welata,
Emisoke nyanja ly' emigongo,"
Eti, "*Ezilinga Kamengo lya Nyakamyoka Kabantende*,

Mwaihyukayo welata"
Bati, "Eho."

Ati, "Nawe bwe mwatuka mwamala mwamusangamu
Ekagolo,
*Ak' omu lwanga,*
*Ka Byantabuzi*, Welata?"
120 Bahi, "Titwamushangamu waitu."
Ahi, "Buga bwangu.
Timumanyile Kagolo naija kufulungula enyanja,
Abana bali aha buziba, Welata."

Return to singing
Ya-ya Ya-ya Ya-ya Ya-ya Ya-ya Ya-ya

Yagenda yamushwela.
Yamumazamu ebilo binai na bina munana.
Lyamuleeta Kagolo,

*K' omu lwanga,*
*Ka Byantabuzi,*
*.5 Luhuba lwa kachubibya,*
*Butoto bwa kyomya,*
*Ow' enkokola zabaile igandami.*

PLOT OUTLINE

Lines 126-132.2
At the lake Kagoro calls to Mugasha, who tries to hide himself. Kagoro strikes Mugasha in the leg with an arrow.

NOTES

142-142.1 *I have nothing, nothing to compare it to*, a confession of defeat: Wamala's rhetorical inability to make comparisons is equated with his lack of physical mastery.

142.3-142.8 *mushambya...coffee tree... mukanshe...*In the later version, Habib describes how Kagolo tries a succession of bows, but each one breaks under his great strength.

143-143.3 Kagolo's power to alter natrual species recalls that of Wamala.

145 *Looked over with one eye*. To look at a person briefly, with the head turned making one eye prominent communicates a hostile, or at least not a friendly, disposition.

POETIC STANZAS

122.8-124.2: compound stanza in **aa**a**b**, 2 + 2 + 2 + 1, formed by utterances in couplets (**a**'s: 122.8-122.9, 122.10-123, 124-124.1) that cohere by enjambment, authorial reference (aside), and by chaining, contrasted with a single line utterance (**b**: 124.2) that abruptly changes topic and finalizes the exchange.

124.3-124.8: compound stanza in **aab**, 2 + 2 + 2, formed by couplets that cohere by parallelism and repetiton (**a**'s: 124.3-124.4, 124.5-124.6) contrasted with a couplet that coheres as a number sequence.

125-125.3: stanza in **abab** formed by contrast between lines that constitute dependent clauses (**a**'s: 125, 125.2) and lines, each an independant clause, that are composed as [plant name] + "changed" + plant name (**b**'s: 125.1, 125.3).

On that day when he had come,
He said, "Where is she, our child Lyanyaibungo?"

.10 Her father said, "The Trapper took her."
I saw his father confounded on that day.

He said, "My child, I have nothing,
Nothing to compare it to."
Kagolo said, "Give me my bow."

They gave him one of the *mushambya* tree,
*Stretcher Bearer*.
They gave him one of the coffee tree.
.5 He took it. He strung it.
He took a bow of the *mukanshe* tree.
He went with eight arrows in his quiver.
The ninth went in his hand,
saying clacking words.

125 In the places where he passed were plantain plants.
They became raphia palms.
When he reached the main road,
*Mushunshu* plants became *bjieela*.

On that day I saw
Kagolo came to the great lake Lwelu.
He called, "Mugasha, come carry me.
I would go and see our child Lyanyaibungo
*Bull of the Pretty Kalaito*."

Mugasha looked over with one eye.
He said, "There is Kagolo *of the Spirit Shrine*."
He got a cloud of lake flies and hid inside.

Kagolo let fly eight arrows.
They fell into the lake.
The ninth caught Mugasha in the leg.
He was startled "I've been pricked by the spike
of an *enkolongo* fish."

Kil' ekyo olwo yakaizile,
Ati, "Alinkaha omwana waitu Lyanaibungo?"

.10 Ishe ati, "Akamutwala Njwenge."
Nkabona ishe yashobelwa kil' ekyo.

Ati, "Mwana wange tinyina,
Tinyina kya kulenga."
Kagolo ahi, "Mpa Obutai bwange."

Bamuha obw' omushambya omwinunula.

Bamuha obw' omumwani.
.5 Yakwata. Yalega.
Yakwat' obw' omukanshe.
Yagenda n' emihambi munana.
Ogwa mwenda gwamugenda omu byala,
ngugamba ejenjenje.

125 Mbali yatwetwe zili ngemu.
Zahinduk' emihunge.
Kayagobile omu kihongolelo,
Emishunshu yahinduk' ebijeela.

Kil' ekyo nkabona
Kagolo yagoba anyanja empango nka Lwelu.
Ati, "Mugasha, ij' ontwale.
Ngye ndebe omwana waitu Lyanyaibungo,
Engundu y' akakalaito."

Mugasha akalebayo limoi.
Ati, "Olinya ni Kagolo K' omu lwanga."
Yaleta eishami yesikiliza.

Kagolo akataishula emihambi munana.
Negwa omu nyanja.
Ogwa mwenda gwamukwata okugulu.
Yechula ahi, "Nakozibwa eihwa ly' enkologo."

PLOT OUTLINE

Lines 133-134.8
Mugasha cuts off his leg and decides to return Wamara's daughter.

POETIC STANZAS

129-132.2: compound stanza in **abab**, 2 + 2 + 2 + 5, formed by contrast between couplets composed as "that day" + I saw [Kagolo]/ "he was confounded" (**a**'s: 129-130, 131-131.1) and lines composed of praisenames (**b**'s: 130.1-130.2, 131.2-132.2).2

I saw Kagolo on that day.
130 Confounded was he,
*Of the Spirit Shrine,*
*Of the Water Oracle.*
I saw on that day
He was confounded, Kagolo,
*Of the Spirit Shrine,*
*Of the Water Oracle.*
*Missile of Despair,*
*Speaker of Angry, Dry Words,*
*With Stiffened Elbows.*

Stop for tape change

I saw on that day
His own leg–the Trapper lopped it off.
He threw it in the lake.
He went inside the Mugoma rocky outcrop.
He took out Lyanyaibungo,
5 *Bull of the Pretty Kalaito.*

He said, "Come I'll take you.
Your people have followed you.
I cannot marry you.
I've been disfigured in my leg, Nyatende
10 (*Bull of*) *The Heart-Tormenters."*

I saw on that day
Mugasha paddled.
That day swiftly, swiftly.

When he had paddled about two miles
He saw that day–
.5 There he stopped, confounded.
He felt great pain.

I saw on that day
His leg, the Trapper–

135 He summoned Thunder, *Essential Warrior*, that day.

Nkabona kil' ekyo Kagolo.
130 Yashobelwa,
*K' omu lwanga,*
*Ka Byantabuzi.*
Nkabona kil' ekyo
Yashobelwa Kagolo,
*K' omu lwanga,*
*Ka Byantabuzi.*
*Luhuba lwa kachubya,*
*Butoto bwa kyomya,*
*Ow' enkokola zabaile igandami.*

Stop for tape change

Nkabona kil' ekyo
Okugulu Njwenge yegutula.
Yanaga omu nyanja.
Yataha omu kyazi ekya Mugoma.
Yamwihyamu Lyanyaibungo,
.5 *Engundu y' akakalaito.*

Ahi, "Ija nkutwale.
Ab' owanu bakuhondile.
Tinakushwela.
Ndemaile kugulu, Nyatende,
.10 *Bashahila mwoyo."*

Nkabona kil' ekyo
Mugasha akabuga.
Kil' ekyo bwangu bwangu.

Kayabugilemu emaili nka ibili
Yabona kil' ekyo
.5 Yaikala ashobeilwe.
Yashalililwa.

Nkabona kil' ekyo
Okugulu Njwenge -

135 Yabilikila Nkuba Kanyalumanzi kil' ekyo

PLOT OUTLINE

Lines 135-147.3
Mugasha orders Thunderstorm to split a boulder and trap Kagoro with only his head above. He beats Kagoro until he loses the power of rational speech. Mugasha concludes with a proverb on the importance of equal exchange.

NOTES

136 -136.1 [When he let loose... ]: apparantly a mistake, quickly corrected.
139-139.1 *Ashy-colored one...who jumps about* are praise names of Mugasha. The dominant criteria for a good appearance are the opposite of these: a smooth, well oiled skin and a smooth, unhurried gait. These negative values are part of a style of self-praise which "makes oneself small" using un-heroic descriptions with ironic intent; this mode is consistent with Mugasha's relatively low social status.

POETIC STANZAS

137.1-137.3: stanza in **aab** formed by contrast between lines that costitute dependent clauses and begin with an adverbial past perfect (**a**'s: 137.1, 137.2) and a single line of quoted speech.

138-141.2: compound stanza in **aab**, 2 + 2 + 9, formed by contrast between couplets referring to Mugasha composed as locutive + "I have come" + subject (name or praisename)/ praisename (**a**'s: 138-138.1, 139-139.2) and lines referring to Kagolo that begin identically, but append many more praisenames (**b**'s: 139.3-141.2).

He said, "Be quick!
I would meet Kagolo at the landing.
He'll have nothing to compare it to."
[*False start* When he let loose a single bolt that day
He hit him on the head with an oar]

On that day he let loose a single bolt.
Kagolo plunged into Kabyantabuzi rock.
I saw him sink down that day, his legs and backside . . .

When only his head was left above the rock,
When Mugasha came,
He said, "You, Kagolo,"
He said, "I–Nyatende–have come.
*An only child, I ended my mother's childlessness."*
He said, *"I–the Ashy-colored one–have come,*
*One who jumps about*."
And he said, "I–Kagolo–have come,
*Of the Spirit Shrine,*
*Of the Water Oracle,*
140 *Missile of Despair,*
*Speaker of Angry, Dry Words,*
*With Stiffened Elbows*.
*Adorned with beads all over except the palm,*
*Of the Left-handers,*
*Of the Water Oracle*."

I saw that day
Kagolo had nothing to compare it to.
He said, "You, Kagolo! Get up, let's fight."
He refused.
He said, "Ti ti ti ti ti ti ti ti."
The paddle hit Kagolo's head.
He said, "Come out, let's fight
I–the Trapper–have come."
He said, "Ti ti ti ti ti ti ti ti."

145 I saw on that day
*Majambwe, Bull of the Heart-Tormenters,*
*Speaker from the Womb,*
*He comes from Mutoizi,*

Ati, "Yanguha bwangu.
Nshange Kagolo aha mwalo.
Ataina kyakulenga."
[Kayaihyamu olulabyo lumoi kil' ekyo
Yamutela engahi omu mutwe]

Kil' ekyo yaihyamu olulabyo lumoi.
Yatobela omu lwazi Kabyantabuzi.
Nkabona yatobela amagulu n' enyio kil' ekyo.

Kayasigaize omutwe aha lwazi eigulu,
Kayaizile Mugasha,
Ati, "Iwe Kagolo,"
Ahi, "Naizile Nyatende,
*Omwana omo nkamalila mawe obugumba."*
Ahi, *"Naizile Lukujuju,*
*Lutambuka na msheba*."
Ahi, "Naizile Kagolo,
*K' omu lwanga,*
*Ka Byantabuzi,*
140 *Owa Luhuba lwa kachubya,*
*Butoto bwa kyomya,*
*Nkokola zabaile igandami*,
*Buhunzile bwona busigaize akaganja,*
*Bwa nyin' emosho,*
*Ka Byantabuzi*."

Nkabona kil' ekyo.
Kagolo akaba ataina kyakulenga.
Ati, "Iwe Kagolo! Imuka, tulwane."
Yayanga
Ati, "Ti ti ti ti ti ti ti ti."
Yamutela engahi omu mutwe Kagolo.
Ati, "Lugamu, tulwane.
Naizile Njwenge."
Ahi, "Ti ti ti ti ti ti ti ti."

145 *Nkabona kil' ekyo*.
*Majambwe Engundu ya bashahila mwoyo,*
*Kagambila-nda,*
*Aluga omwa mutoizi,*

PLOT OUTLINE

*The Trapper*.
His paddle hit Kagolo's head.
Kagolo flew out of Kabyantabuzi rock.

*Njwenge*.
Yamutela engahi omu mutwe Kagolo.
Yaluga omu lwazi Kabyantabuzi.

NOTES

147 *Whoever hits your eye...* is a well-known proverb.

He told him, "Whoever hits your eye–you hit his nose."

Akamugambila ati, "Akutela elisho -- Omutela enyindo."

Mugasha had one leg to stand on.
But to this day Kagolo never has found a word to say.

Mugasha akemeleza okugulu kumo.
Na mambwenu Kagolo takabonaga kyakugamba.

Nyatende Mugasha.

Nyatende Mugasha.

POETIC STANZAS

147-147.2: stanza in **abb** formed by contrast between a quoted proverb (**a**: 147) and two lines of explication (**b**'s: 147.1, 147.2) each composed as proper noun subject + verb.

# APPENDIX

## LINES APPARENTLY MISSING FROM THIS VERSION, COPIED FROM HABIB'S PERFORMANCE OF MUGASHA RECORDED IN 1980

5 Mugasha's childless aunt starts out as though she will succeed in becoming known as his mother, but her dedication is not sufficient and she fails. The women argue.

5.3 *Child of my mother* and *ancestral spirit* are terms of address that convey both intimacy and respect. Mugasha's aunt asks her sister's help in a difficult task.

7-7.3 This belief about the unsettled nature of a deceased child's spirit is commonly known.

9 Mugasha's aunt's gesture, hand raised with palm outward, usually requests a spirit's help in redressing a wrong.

13 Squatting or sitting with the knees raised is women's characteristic posture for several gender-related acts: giving birth, having sex, urinating, cooking at the hearth, and doing agricultural labor.

13.1 *Kabagala* is a small, heart-shaped hoe that women use to weed crops. It is regarded by some as the earliest form of hoe and therefore the ruler of other hoes. This praise is frequently used about women.

3 All nine women there fell into a quandary.
Confounded they were.

4 That day, Nyatende and Nyambubi
A woman there they call Nyatende,
A sister of Nyambubi.
5 The woman they call Nyatende,
Sister of Nyambubi

That day she spoke to Nyambubi,
"Child of my mother, ancestral spirit
Help me place my feet for mercy's sake
.5 So I can grab my child!"
6 She said, "So I can grab my child.
This very day, I will.

7 "You know that if an only child dies,
It kills the one that bore it;
It brings us haunting;
It returns and brings bad dreams as well.

8 Mugasha's mother's sister waded out in the water.
It grabbed her to the nipples of her breasts.
The woman backed out buttocks first that day.

9 The woman raised her hand as though she laid a curse.

10 I saw her speak to Mugasha.
She said, "I am not the one who gave you birth,
O dear, not I who pushed for you.
Let not the water swallow me, Mugasha!"
The woman backed out buttocks first that day.

Since Mugasha had no one to take him from the lake,
That day he got out from the lake himself.
He got back in the canoe.

And when he reached the shore,
He found them fighting over fish,
.5 *The people of the Peaceful One*
*People of squatting and of iron*,
You know, *people of hoes ruled by* kabagala,
They came to fight.
They quarreled over an *enkuyu* fish,

Abakazi mwenda bona bagw' omu bitangaalo.
Bashobelwa.

Kil' ekyo Nyatende na Nyambubi
Akab' aliw' omukazi mbamweetaNyatende,
Mulumuna Nyambubi iyo-o.
5 Omukazi mbamweeta Nyatende,
Mulumuna Nyambubi.

Kil' ekyo yagambila Nyambubi,
Ati, "Mwaana wa maawe, muchwezi gw' omwaitu
Mbeel' amagulu ob' otaileho kazilo
.5 Kankwaat' omwaana wange 'nye iyo-o."
Ahi, "Kankwaat' omwaana wange,
Kil' ekya mbwenu inye.

"Nomany' omwaana yakuf' ali omoi
Ait' ayakuzaile;
Atuleteil' enchweke;
Agaluka atuleteil' amahunga."

Nyinento Mugasha, maawe, yasabal' omu maizi.
Gamukwaat' omu nnatwa z' amabele.
Omukazi kil' ekyo yagaluky' ekinyainyio.

Omukazi yaimuky' omukono nk' alikuteega.

10 Nkabona yagambila Mugasha
Ahi, "Mwaana wange, tiinye nkuzaile,
Kyonkya kazilo, tiinye nkusindikiile.
K' amaizi gatandya Mugasha!"
Omukazi yagaluky' ekinyainyio kil' ekyo.

Mugasha kayabuzil' ow'okumwihy' omu nyanja,
Kil' ekyo yalug' omu nyanja.
Yagaluk' omu bwato

Kabwagobil' aha mwaalo
Baitanil' esamaki
.5 *Abanyakalembe* *12,*
*Aba Lyabandame na Bwooma*
*Nomany' ab' emfuka itwaalwa Kabagala*
Baija kulwaana.
Mbaitanil' Enkuyu,

# LINES APPARENTLY MISSING FROM THIS VERSION, COPIED FROM HABIB'S PERFORMANCE OF MUGASHA RECORDED IN 1980 CONTINUED

17ff. Kagolo's praise alludes to his hot-headed and warlike behavior, which spirit mediums embody when they are possessed by him.

17.1 *Dry words* are strong and effective, as opposed to 'wet' words, which are weak.

17.2 *Stiff Elbows* probably reflects his demeanor as a possessing spirit; it seems to reinforce in gestural language his extreme and immoderate behavior.

17.5 *The water oracle* (*Byantabuzi*) is associated with this spirit (its name comes from *oku-tabula,* "to make water bubble up or forth"). Byantabuzi also echoes the name of the place where Kagolo acquired his characteristic way of talking (l. 143.3).

19 *Drank it, spilled it, built it, burned it*, refer to the episodes of myths about Kagolo and his grandfather Wamala.

*Big eyes skyward like a forgetful debtor*.

.5 The one said, "I am the one who gave him birth,"
She said, "I am the one who pushed for him."
The other said, "If you gave birth to him, then why
When he fell into the water did you not go grab him?
The one said, "And why
When you went to grab him, did you back out
buttocks first?"

15 Ewewe yo o

It happened that Wamala was there that day.
He showed them the copper spear of Kagolo,
*Missle that causes envy,*
*Dry words spoken in fury*
*Stiff elbows,*
*All adorned in beads except the palm,*
*Of the left-handers,*
.5 *Of the water oracle;*
*He drank it–he spilled it,*
*He built it–he burned it,*
*Pouncer on warriors.*

20 Wamala said, "You nine women, as you are here,
Make a judgement, my children"
He said, "If a warrior woman steps forward and spears
Mugasha and kills him,
I will give her nine children."
And to show how much they want to reproduce, my lord,
The *People of the Peaceful-one*
Mugasha's mother's sister said, "Let me spear Mugasha. I'll kill him.
They'll give me the nine children.
These cannot be compared to the single child of
Nyambubi."

E wewe e

25 When she raised the spear . . . [resume 1950 version at Line 61 on page 7}

*Bilali bya kahunga.*

.5 Ogw' ati, "Ninye muzaile."
N'ogw' ati, "Ninye musindikile."
Ogw' ati, "Komuzaile, olwo yagw' omu nyanja,
Nk' otagya kukumkwaata?"
Ogw' ati, "Kawagya kumukwaata,
Nka wagaluky' ekinyainyio?"

15 Ewewe yo-o

Akashangwa aliwo Wamala kil' ekyo.
Yabah' eichumu ly' omulinga elya Kagolo.
*Elya Luhuuba lwa Kachubya*
*Butoto bwa Kyoomya*
*Ow' enkokola zabaile igandami*
*Buhunzile bwoona busigaiz' akaganja*
*Bwa nyin' emosho,*
.5 *Kabyantabuuzi;*
*Agunywana agushesha;*
*Agombeka agookya,*
*Lutumbika manzi.*

20 Wamala ati, "Inyw' abakazi mwend' okwo muli aha
Mbalamule baana bange"
Ati, "Aluge' omukazi emanzi achumite Mugasha amwite

Ndamuha abaana mwenda."
Mala kumanya bagonz' oluzaalo, waitu,
*Abanyakalembe*
Nyinento Mugasha ahi, "Kanchumite Mugasha mwite.
Balamp' abaana mwenda.
Tibalikwigana mwan' omo wa Nyambubi."

E wewe-e

25 Kayalyetwekile . . .